



Build your own Daemon Prince

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When we reviewed the first Total War: Warhammer game we were pretty smitten, and we recall saying that it was a match made in heaven. Two more instalments down the line, that sentiment still stands. While we were certainly wondering what direction Creative Assembly would take with Total War: Warhammer III, what we got was actually a bit of a surprise, and not necessarily in a bad way.

Story – Off to hell we go

The game starts off with the prologue, which not only does a decent job of teaching you the ropes, but also functions as the reason the entire game's campaign is taking place. You're put in the shoes of the Prince of Kislev, who's fighting his way to Ursun, the bear God

of the Kislev, who has somehow been imprisoned by the daemon Be'lakor. Along the way, the prince is corrupted by Chaos, so when he finally makes it to Ursun, he shoots him with a cursed bullet. Ursun's deafening cries of pain are powerful enough to open rifts between realities, allowing armies from different planes to cross over into the Realms of Chaos. Here, depending on the faction you're playing as, your goal may vary.

All of this leads to a very unique Total War campaign experience. The priority is no longer the usual conquering of the entire map, but making it to Ursun's prison before everyone else. Every 30ish or so turns, you have rifts opening up all over the map, spewing out daemon armies, and through these same rifts you can enter the Realms of Chaos. Once through the rift, you will need to test your armies' mettle against one of

the daemon princes. These involve massive survival battles against the armies of daemon princes. The reward for doing so is the soul of the daemon prince.

The rifts create a sense of urgency. The goal is to be the first to get four souls, so you can choose to strategically let a soul go if you know you're ahead and focus on your own territory or expansion. This also means that when the end is near, you might need to act quickly if another faction is also in the race to claim their fourth soul.

The game still gives you a chance to come back in case an opponent beats you to the fourth soul, which is nice. If you were unable to stop an opposing faction from claiming their fourth soul, you need to beeline to Ursun's prison and defeat the approaching army.

We can't recall any other Total War campaign experience quite like this one,